MAP YOUR SOCIAL LOCATION · PART 1 OF 3

The parts of you

Psychologist Pamela Hays made a list called ADDRESSING. Each letter is one part of who we are. Write whatever comes up, and skip anything that doesn't feel right today.

A

AGE AND GENERATION

What was happening in the world while you grew up, and how did it shape what feels normal to you?

D

DEVELOPMENTAL DISABILITY

Growing up, were the places around you built for the way your body and mind work?

D

DISABILITY LATER IN LIFE

Has an illness, injury, or change in your body or mind changed how the world treats you?

R

RELIGION AND SPIRITUALITY

What did your family believe, and what do you believe now?

E

ETHNIC AND RACIAL IDENTITY

How do you describe your ethnicity and race? How do other people describe it?

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The parts of you

S **SOCIOECONOMIC STATUS**

Growing up, did money feel steady or uncertain? What about now?

S **SEXUAL ORIENTATION**

When have you felt free, or not free, to be open about who you love?

I **INDIGENOUS HERITAGE**

Do you have Indigenous roots? Whose land do you live on now?

N **NATIONAL ORIGIN**

Where were you born, where were your parents born, and what language did you hear at home?

G **GENDER**

What did people expect of you because of your gender?

LOOK BACK

Which parts do you think about almost every day? Which ones rarely cross your mind?

The parts we rarely think about are often the ones where the world was already built for us. Peggy McIntosh (1989) called this an invisible backpack of advantages.

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MAP YOUR SOCIAL LOCATION · PART 2 OF 3

Where the parts overlap

In 1989, law professor Kimberlé Crenshaw named this intersectionality. The parts of us overlap, and the overlap can matter more than any one part alone.

In a 1976 case, Black women sued General Motors. The court said there was no race discrimination because GM hired Black men, and no sex discrimination because GM hired white women. The women who were both Black and women fell through the gap.

QUESTION 1

Has there been a time when two parts of you together changed how you were treated, more than either one would alone?

QUESTION 2

Which of your parts seem to get noticed first by other people? Which ones stay hidden?

QUESTION 3

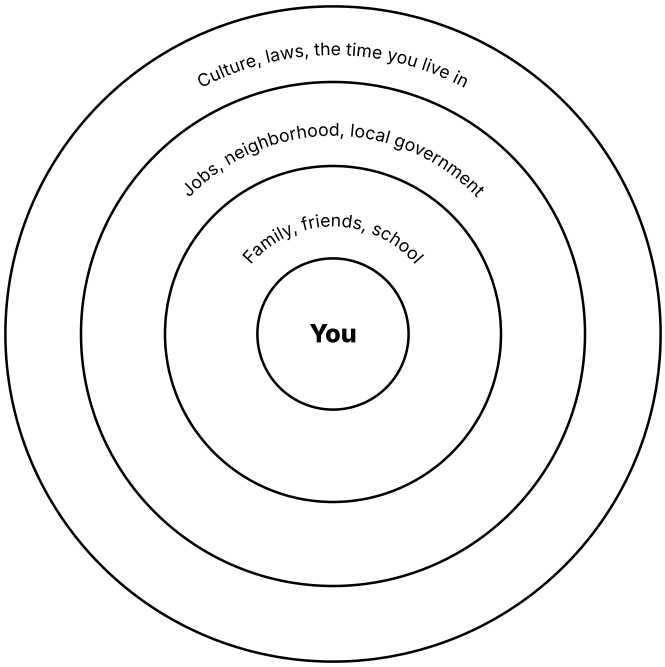
Pick one part you rarely think about. What might someone who stands in a different place on that part have to think about every day?

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MAP YOUR SOCIAL LOCATION · PART 3 OF 3

The circles around you

Psychologist Urie Bronfenbrenner pictured a person in the middle of circles. Write names, places, and events in each ring.



CLOSEST CIRCLE

Who was around you every day growing up? Who is around you now?

THE CIRCLES YOU NEVER SAW

What decisions shaped your life that you weren't in the room for, like a parent's work schedule or a school's budget?

THE OUTER CIRCLE

What did your culture and your country tell you a good life looks like? Do you still believe it?

TIME

What big events happened during your life, and how old were you when they did?

Sources: Hays, *Addressing Cultural Complexities in Practice* (APA, 3rd ed., 2016). Crenshaw, "Demarginalizing the Intersection of Race and Sex," *University of Chicago Legal Forum* (1989). *DeGraffenreid v. General Motors* (E.D. Mo. 1976). McIntosh, "White Privilege: Unpacking the Invisible Knapsack" (1989). Bronfenbrenner, *The Ecology of Human Development* (Harvard, 1979).

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